

# Business Startup Checklist

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## The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

### Phase 1 — Legal & Financial (Week 1)

- ☐ Form LLC and obtain EIN
- ☐ Open business bank account
- ☐ Purchase general liability insurance (\$1M/\$2M)
- ☐ Get local business license if required
- ☐ Set up basic accounting (Wave is free to start)
- ☐ Create business phone and email

### Phase 2 — Brand & Online Presence (Week 1–2)

- ☐ Choose company name and tagline
- ☐ Design logo (Canva or hire on Fiverr)
- ☐ Register domain and build simple website
- ☐ Set up Google Business Profile
- ☐ Create Yelp business page
- ☐ Create Instagram and Facebook business pages
- ☐ Join Nextdoor as a business
- ☐ Take 10–20 before/after photos for marketing

### Phase 3 — Operations Setup (Week 2)

- ☐ Purchase starter supply kit (see Product Shopping List)
- ☐ Buy uniform(s) — branded polo or all black
- ☐ Set pricing (see Pricing Guide — do NOT charge hourly)
- ☐ Create estimate/quote template
- ☐ Set up Stripe or Square for payments
- ☐ Print or digitize all SOP checklists
- ☐ Create customer intake form
- ☐ Write cancellation policy

## Phase 4 — First Clients (Week 2–4)

- ☐ Offer 3–5 discounted "portfolio" cleans to friends/family for photos & reviews
- ☐ Ask every happy client for a Google and Yelp review
- ☐ Post before/after content on social media
- ☐ Launch referral program (\$25 off for referrer + referee)
- ☐ Respond to every inquiry within 1 hour

## Phase 5 — Scale Readiness (Month 2+)

- ☐ Document every process as an SOP
- ☐ Track time per job to validate pricing
- ☐ Set profit targets (aim for \$50+ per regular clean minimum)
- ☐ Build lead list / CRM (spreadsheet or free CRM)
- ☐ Plan first hire when consistently booked 4+ days/week

## Startup Budget Snapshot

| Category               | Estimated Cost       |
|------------------------|----------------------|
| LLC + licenses         | \$100–\$500          |
| Insurance (annual)     | \$400–\$1,200        |
| Supplies & equipment   | \$300–\$800          |
| Website & branding     | \$0–\$500            |
| Uniforms               | \$50–\$150           |
| Marketing (initial)    | \$0–\$300            |
| <b>Total to launch</b> | <b>\$850–\$3,450</b> |

## Success Metrics — First 90 Days

| Metric           | Target           |
|------------------|------------------|
| Completed cleans | 20+              |
| Google reviews   | 10+ (4.8+ stars) |
| Repeat clients   | 30% of bookings  |

|                        |                         |
|------------------------|-------------------------|
| Average job profit     | \$50+ per regular clean |
| Response time to leads | Under 1 hour            |